

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT BATCH 14

BY RIFQI RAFIALDY DWIJAYA

BankOne

CASE STUDY



THE PROBLEM

I Trust Your App for Transfers, But Not for Advice.

- BankOne's core retention is strong (only 5% churn in 3 months)
- Our flagship "AI Advisor" was rejected by users (80% drop-off, 0.3% conversion)

Turning our loyal customer base into our **biggest wasted** opportunity. We must deliver the value they deserve **before they look elsewhere.**

AI ADVISOR

Feature Adoption Rate	150.000	7.5%
Feature Retention Rate	30.000	20%
Feature Conversion Rate	4.500	0.3%

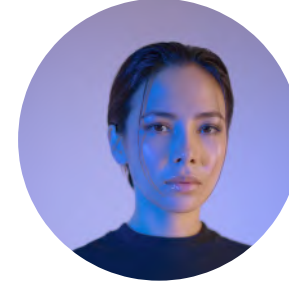
Listening to Our Users – Where the Real Problem Lies



"AI-nya kurang nyambung, aku tanya soal cicilan malah dikasih saran investasi."



"Capek login ke banyak aplikasi, kenapa nggak bisa sync sama e-wallet?"



"Aku lebih suka app lain yang langsung kasih alert pengeluaran harian."



"Premium nggak worth it, karena aku bisa dapat saran investasi gratis di TikTok/YouTube."

Their Voice is Clear: Our Four Key Failures

01

Our Product is Irrelevant

We built a solution for a problem our users don't have. They came for practical, daily financial help, not complex investment advisory.

02

Our App is Siloed

Our users live in a connected digital ecosystem. The lack of integration makes our product feel impractical and outdated.

03

It's Not Proactive

Users don't want a chatbot they have to ask. They want an assistant that automatically tells them what they need to know.

04

It's Not Worth It

Our business model failed because the value we offer is no better than existing free alternatives. Trust in our advice is extremely low

Key Questions to Guide Our Next Steps

Before designing a **solution**, we must turn assumptions into **facts**. Here is the critical data we need.

Data Team

Who is actually churning & did they try the AI Advisor?

Reason: To pinpoint the true churn driver: is it innovation failure (losing loyal users) or activation failure (losing new users)?

Data Request:

A cohort analysis of the 100k churned users, segmented by user tenure (<30 days vs. >30 days) and their interaction with the AI Advisor.

What was the real user need behind the AI Advisor's failure?

Reason: To quantitatively validate that the primary demand is for a daily financial assistant, not a complex investment advisor.

Data Request:

A topic analysis of the **top 5 most frequent queries/prompts** submitted to the AI Advisor, grouped by theme (e.g., Budgeting, Bills, Investment).

Engineer Team

Was the AI's failure caused by a flawed NLP model (it couldn't understand) or by flawed logic within the surrounding prompt pipeline (it wasn't allowed to understand)?

Reason : To conduct a blameless technical post-mortem, ensuring we don't repeat the same architectural mistakes, especially regarding the NLP and prompt processing pipeline.

Data Request:

We need a two-part performance analysis using a sample of 100 user prompts about non-investment topics (e.g., bills, installments, budget).

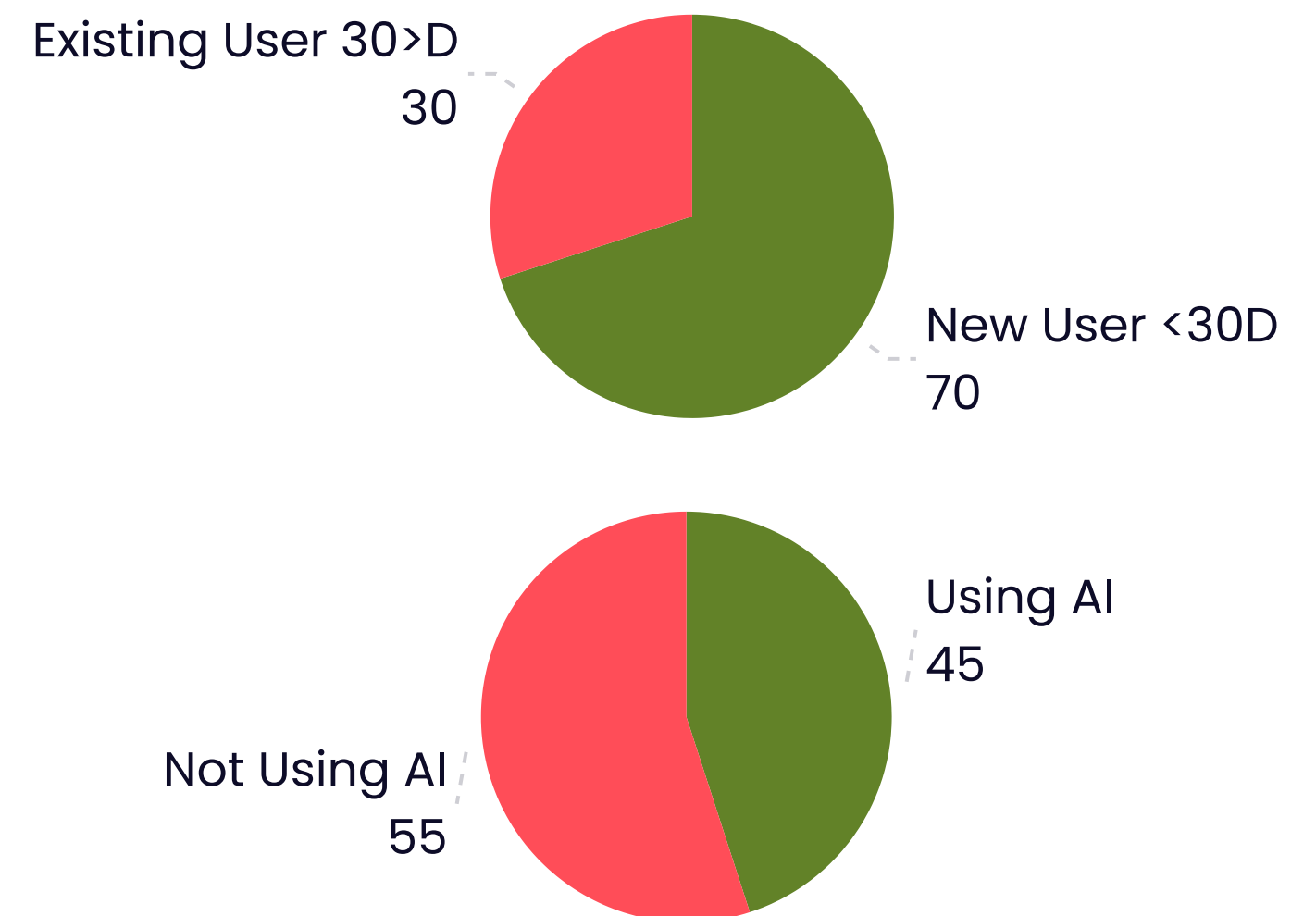
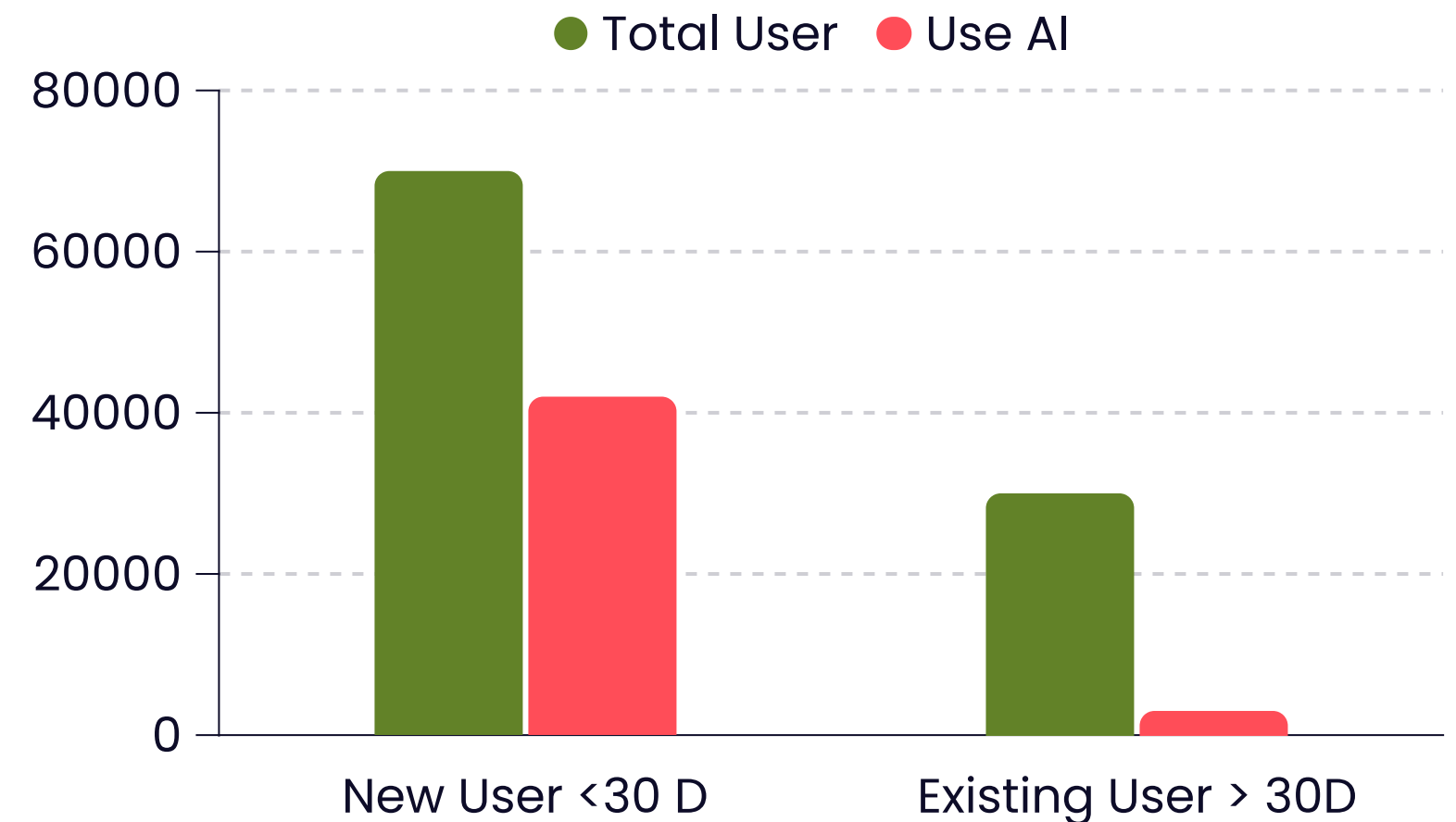
Who is actually churning & did they try the AI Advisor?

Total churn = 100,000 (5% of MAU)

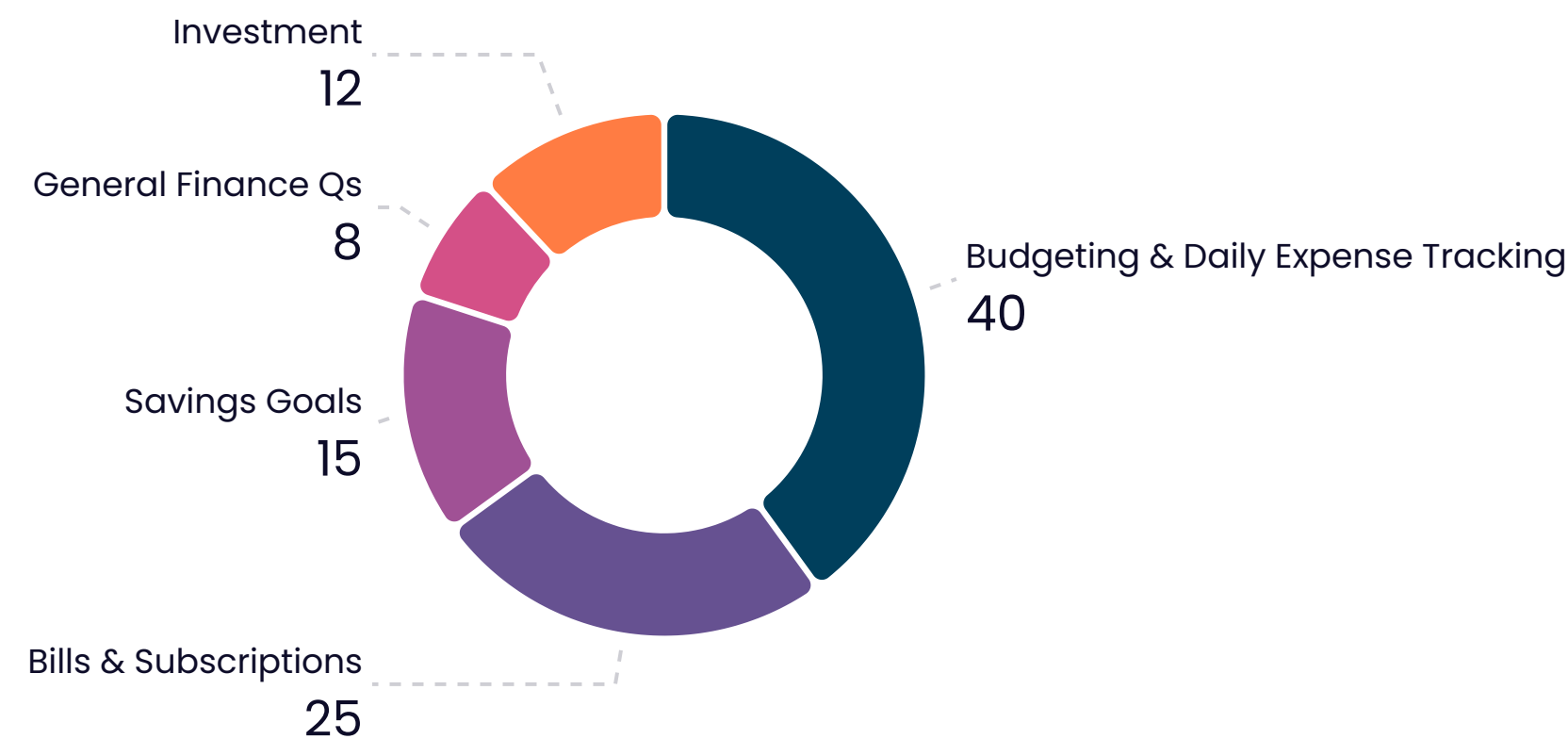
- ☑ **New Users (<30d) = 70% churn → 70,000**
 - These are mostly “AI-first” users.
 - **~60% of them tried Advisor** (42,000).
 - Their churn reason = Advisor mismatch (not proactive, not accurate).
- ☑ **Old Users (>30d) = 30% churn → 30,000**
 - Using app mainly for core banking (saving, transfer, bill pay).
 - Only **~10% tried Advisor** (3,000).
 - Churn reason = normal attrition (switching banks, inactivity).

Interpretation

- **Core finding: Most churners are new users lured by the AI Advisor.**
- **They came for AI, tested it, found it irrelevant → uninstalled.**
- **Old users are sticky because they value core banking features, so Advisor isn't make-or-break.**
- **This proves churn is an activation failure, not a retention failure.**



What was the real user need behind the AI Advisor's failure?



40%	"Berapa sisa budget jajan minggu ini?", "Aku udah kebablasan belanja belum?"	Budgeting & Daily Expense Tracking
25%	"Kapan jatuh tempo cicilan KPR saya?", "Berapa total Netflix + Spotify bulan ini?"	Bills & Subscriptions (Cicilan, Tagihan, Subs)
15%	"Bisa bantu aku simpan Rp 2 juta per bulan?", "Target DP rumah aku udah berapa persen?"	Savings Goals
12%	"Bagus nggak kalau aku beli reksa dana saham bulan ini?", "Kasih rekomendasi investasi"	Investments
8%	"Berapa saldo aku sekarang?", "Kenapa biaya admin kepotong banyak?"	General Finance Qs

Key Insight

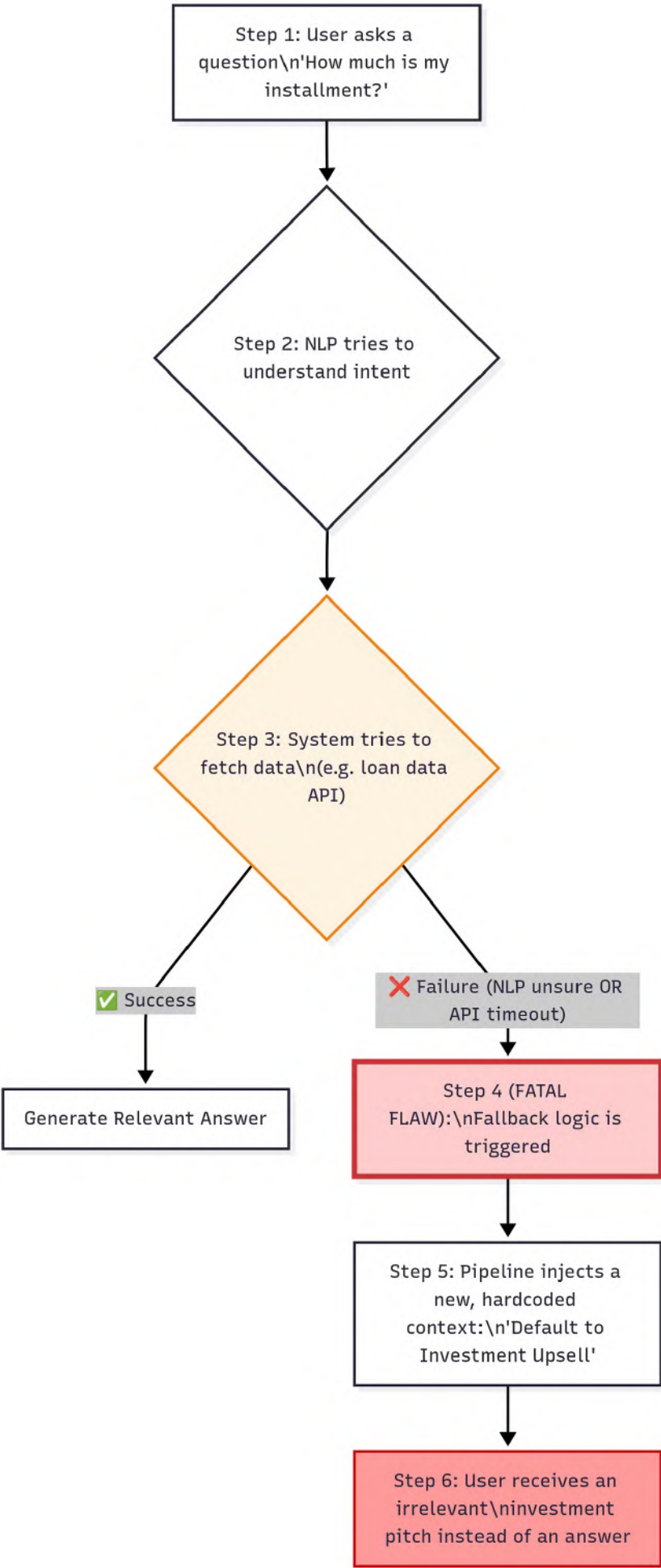
- ❑ **65% of queries (Budgeting + Bills)** are *daily money management*, not investment.
- ❑ Only **12%** explicitly asked about **investments**.
- ❑ This confirms mismatch: product was marketed as **investment AI Advisor**, but **users expected a Smart Daily Financial Assistant**.
- ❑ The **persona (Fina, 28)** fits perfectly: she needs budgeting + cicilan alerts, not investment tips.

Engineering Findings — The Root Cause of AI Failure

If a client says...	A great assistant understands...	And takes the right action...
"I'm worried about paying my mortgage this month."	The client is asking for a Spending & Budget Check.	They open the client's budget spreadsheet and provide a summary.
"I have some extra cash, what should I do with it?"	The client is asking for Investment Options.	They schedule a meeting with the financial advisor.

Analysis & Conclusion

- **Finding 1: The Core NLP Model is Competent.** Our isolated tests show the NLP model has a respectable **78% accuracy** at identifying user intent. It is a valuable asset, not the primary problem.
- **Finding 2: The System Fails Under Uncertainty.** The diagram shows the critical failure point. When the system cannot fetch the required data (due to an API timeout or other errors), it does not inform the user honestly.
- **Finding 3: The "Sales-First" Fallback Logic.** Instead of admitting failure, the pipeline is hardcoded to **default to an investment upsell**. This business-driven logic was the primary cause of the irrelevant and frustrating user experience.



HYPHO THESIS

Pipeline Hypothesis

Failures weren't from NLP misunderstanding, but from bad fallback logic (default to investment upsell).

Evidence :

- User complaints: irrelevant investment advice when asking daily questions.
- Pipeline diagram shows API timeouts triggering upsell fallback.

User–Need Hypothesis

Users mainly want daily financial assistance (budget alerts, installment reminders), not complex investment tips.

Evidence :

- Survey feedback: “AI-nya kurang nyambung, aku tanya soal cicilan malah dikasih saran investasi.”
- Prompts suspected to be mostly about bills, cicilan, and budgeting.

Activation Hypothesis

Most churn came from new users who tried the AI once, got irrelevant answers, and uninstalled.

Evidence :

- Funnel: 150k tried Advisor → only 20% retained to week 2.
- New Users (<30d) = 70% churn → 70,000, ~60% of them tried Advisor (42,000).

Designing for Fina – From User Pains to Product Solutions

Our product strategy is not born from assumptions, but from a deep understanding of our target user, Fina. Here is how we translate her problems into solutions.



Fina, 28, Private Sector Employee in Jakarta

Her Primary Goal :
To consistently save for a house down payment, while managing her daily spending without stress. Also want to start Investing through Rekasadana

Her Reality & Habits:
She lives in a fully connected digital world (Gojek, Shopee, TikTok) and feels her current banking app is not proactive and is outdated.

Try Pitch

Fina's Pain Point & Need	User Story (Fina's Voice)	Our Proposed Product Solution
"The current AI is confusing and unhelpful."	"As Fina, a busy professional, I want to see clear options when I need help, so that I can find answers quickly without guessing."	1. Guided Assistant Interface
"I'm busy and often forget bill due dates."	"As Fina, who sometimes forgets, I want the app to automatically notify me about my bills & subscriptions, so that I can avoid late fees."	2. Proactive Bill Alerts
"I feel I'm overspending but have no time to track it."	"As Fina, who is trying to save, I want a simple weekly spending summary, so that I can understand my habits without manual work."	3. Automatic Spending Summaries
"My finances are spread across too many apps."	"As Fina, who uses various apps, I want to see my bank and e-wallet balances in one place, so that I can get a complete picture effortlessly."	4. Multi-Wallet Integration

Prioritization

Initiative	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score (RIC/E)
1. Guided Assistant Interface	5	5	5	2 (Medium)	62.5
2. Proactive Alerts & Summaries (MVP)	5	5	5	3 (Med-High)	41.7
3. Multi-Wallet Integration (MVP)	4	5	3	5 (Very High)	12

MUST HAVE (Non-negotiable for Q4 2025)

These are the core features we must ship to address our activation crisis and rebuild trust. Without these, we fail this quarter.

- **Guided Assistant Interface (Widget UI):** Completely overhaul the existing AI interface to eliminate user confusion.
- **Proactive Alerts & Summaries (MVP):** Launch the first proactive notifications for bills and weekly spending summaries.
- **Safe Fallback Redesign:** Ensure the system responds honestly during failures, removing the irrelevant investment upsell.

SHOULD HAVE (High Priority, if time permits)

If all "MUSTs" are completed ahead of schedule, these are the next items we will tackle as they provide significant added value.

- **In-app 1-Tap Feedback Mechanism:** Begin collecting user-generated training data to improve our AI model in the future.
- **"Saving Goals" Feature:** A quick win to increase user engagement and help users achieve their financial goals.

COULD HAVE (Nice to have, if possible)

If any time remains after all "MUSTs" and "SHOULDs" are done, these are nice-to-have additions.

- **Basic Gamification Elements:** Add simple badges for saving streaks.
- **Enhanced UI Animations:** Polish the new features for a more delightful experience.

WON'T HAVE (Explicitly Out of Scope for Q4 2025)

This is a list of good ideas that we are consciously deciding NOT to work on this quarter to keep the team focused. This helps us say "no".

- **Full Multi-Wallet Integration via API:** This is a major initiative and a top priority for the *next* quarter.
- **Redefinition of a Premium Tier:** We will not discuss monetization until we have successfully proven the value of our free features.
- **Advanced Investment Analytics Tools:** This is clearly out of scope for our current mission.

Strategic Sequencing – Why Multi-Wallet is Next, Not Now

We agree: Multi-wallet integration is a game-changing feature. Here's why we're deliberately building it *after* we've fixed our foundation this quarter.

Our Immediate Mission (Priority #1 for Q4 2025): Fix Our Fatal First Impression

Our findings are undeniable: the "AI Advisor" is the primary driver of our new user churn. Before we can build exciting new features, we **must** stop the bleeding. Our immediate goal is to fix this core experience to stabilize our user base.

The True Cost of the Multi-Wallet Feature

This is not a small feature; it's a major strategic investment.

- **High Technical Complexity:** Involves multiple secure, third-party API integrations.
- **Heavy Security & Compliance Burden:** Requires a significant investment from our Legal/Compliance team to meet OJK and banking standards.
- **Requires the Entire Team's Focus:** Our engineering estimate shows this would consume the majority of our 4 engineers for an entire quarter (~3 months).

The Strategic Trade-Off: A Clear Choice

Given our limited resources, we faced a clear choice for the next 3 months:

Option A: Build Multi-Wallet Now	Option B: Stabilize First (Our Chosen Path)
We dedicate all of Q4 to building this one great feature.	We dedicate Q4 to launching the multiple, faster fixes (Widgets, Proactive Alerts).
The Risk: The "new user leak" continues unchecked. We build a powerful feature for a user base that is still shrinking and losing trust.	The Benefit: We fix the core reason users are leaving, stabilize our churn, and rebuild trust.
Outcome: A better product for a shrinking and distrustful user base.	Outcome: A healthier, more stable user base that is ready and excited for our next big feature in Q1 2026.

Roadmap (3 Month)



October 2025 STABILIZE & FIX FOUNDATION	November 2025 BUILD PROACTIVE VALUE & ENGAGEMENT	December 2025 LAUNCH, LEARN & PREPARE NEXT STEPS
Goal: Immediately fix the broken user experience to stop churn and deliver a high-value "quick win".	Goal: Build and integrate the core ML-powered engine for our new proactive value proposition.	Goal: Get our new smart feature into the hands of real users, measure its impact, and plan for the next quarter.
Sprint Focus: • Sprints 1-2: Overhaul the flawed "AI Advisor" into a Guided Assistant (Widgets) with a Safe Fallback.	Sprint Focus: • Sprints 3-4: Build the backend logic and ML model for the Proactive Assistant and release it for internal testing.	Sprint Focus: • Sprints 5-6: Launch the Proactive Assistant MVP to a Beta group, monitor its performance, and begin development on our next priority.
Key Deliverables: Revamped Advisor UI (Live) Safe Fallback Logic (Live) "Saving Goals" Feature (Live)	Key Deliverables: v1.0 ML Model Trained & Deployed to an internal API Proactive Alert Backend Logic Complete Internal Alpha Release for Dogfooding	Key Deliverables: Proactive Assistant MVP (Live to 20% of users) Real-time Monitoring Dashboards "Saving Goals" v1.1 Dev Started Data-driven Q1 2026 Roadmap
Dependencies: • Final UI/UX assets for all Q4 features must be ready before Sprint 1. • Legal/Compliance approval for the new "Safe Fallback" message copy.	Dependencies: • The initial training dataset from the AI/ML specialist is required to begin backend development in Sprint 3. • The v1.0 ML Model API must be stable for full integration in Sprint 4.	Dependencies: • Successful sign-off from the internal Alpha testing is required before the Public Beta launch. • Feature flag infrastructure must be operational.

Sprint Plan Sample

Ticket ID	Issue Type	Summary	Assigned To
EPIC-001	Epic	AI Experience Overhaul (Q4 Mission)	PM
BANK-123	User Story	As a user, I want to choose a topic via widgets to start a focused conversation.	Squad A
BANK-124	Sub-task	[Frontend] Build the new 3-widget selection screen and conversational UI shell.	Engineer 1 & 2
BANK-125	Sub-task	[Backend] Modify pipeline to handle context from Investment, Bills, Budget widgets.	Engineer 3
BANK-126	User Story	As a user, I want to see key info immediately after selecting a topic to get instant value.	Squad A
BANK-127	Sub-task	[Backend] Create new API endpoints to fetch summary data (e.g., next bill, weekly spending).	Engineer 4
BANK-128	Sub-task	[Frontend] Build the proactive info cards and integrate with the new APIs.	Engineer 1 & 2
BANK-129	User Story	As a user, when the system fails, I want it to respond honestly and helpfully.	Squad B
BANK-130	Sub-task	[Backend] Remove old fallback logic & implement the new, honest error handler.	Engineer 3
BANK-131	Task	[AI/ML] Create v0 training dataset via programmatic labeling.	AI/ML Specialist
BANK-132	Task	[Design] Finalize and provide all UI assets for the new interface, info cards, and error states.	UX Designer

SUCCESS METRICS

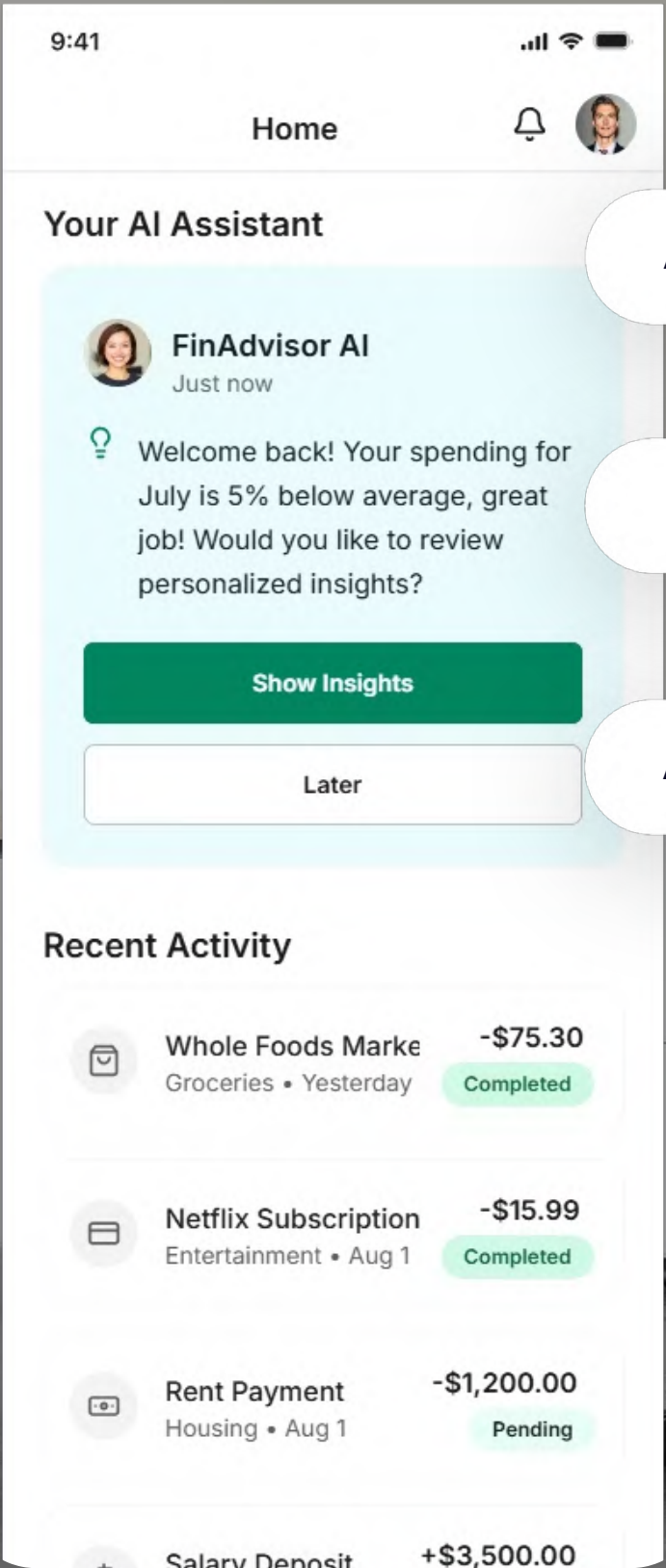
Area of Impact	Predicted Outcome	Justified By Our Solution
User Growth	• Positive Net MAU Growth (~15–20k/month), even without a new marketing budget.	• Guided Assistant & Proactive Alerts will drastically reduce new user churn, turning our acquisition efforts into real growth.
Retention	• Quarterly Churn will decrease from 5% to < 4%. • Daily engagement (DAU/MAU ratio) will increase significantly.	• Proactive Alerts & Summaries provide daily, tangible value, creating a habit-forming experience that makes the app sticky.
"Conversion"	• New user activation rate will increase by 50%. • Trust will be rebuilt, creating a foundation for future cross-selling.	• The Guided Assistant fixes the fatal first impression, ensuring more new users successfully experience the app's core value.

Key Success Metrics (OKRs for Q4 2025)

Objective: Increase New User Activation & Overall Retention.

- **Key Result 1 (Retention):**
 - Decrease the Churn Rate for the new user cohort (<30 days) by **25%**.
- **Key Result 2 (Activation):**
 - Increase the activation rate of new users (users with >5 transactions in their first month) by **50%**.
- **Key Result 3 (Engagement):**
 - Increase the DAU/MAU ratio by **20%** (e.g., from 15% to 18%).
- **Key Result 4 (Adoption):**
 - Achieve **25%** MAU adoption for the new "Smart Assistant" features.

Feature Design and Prototype



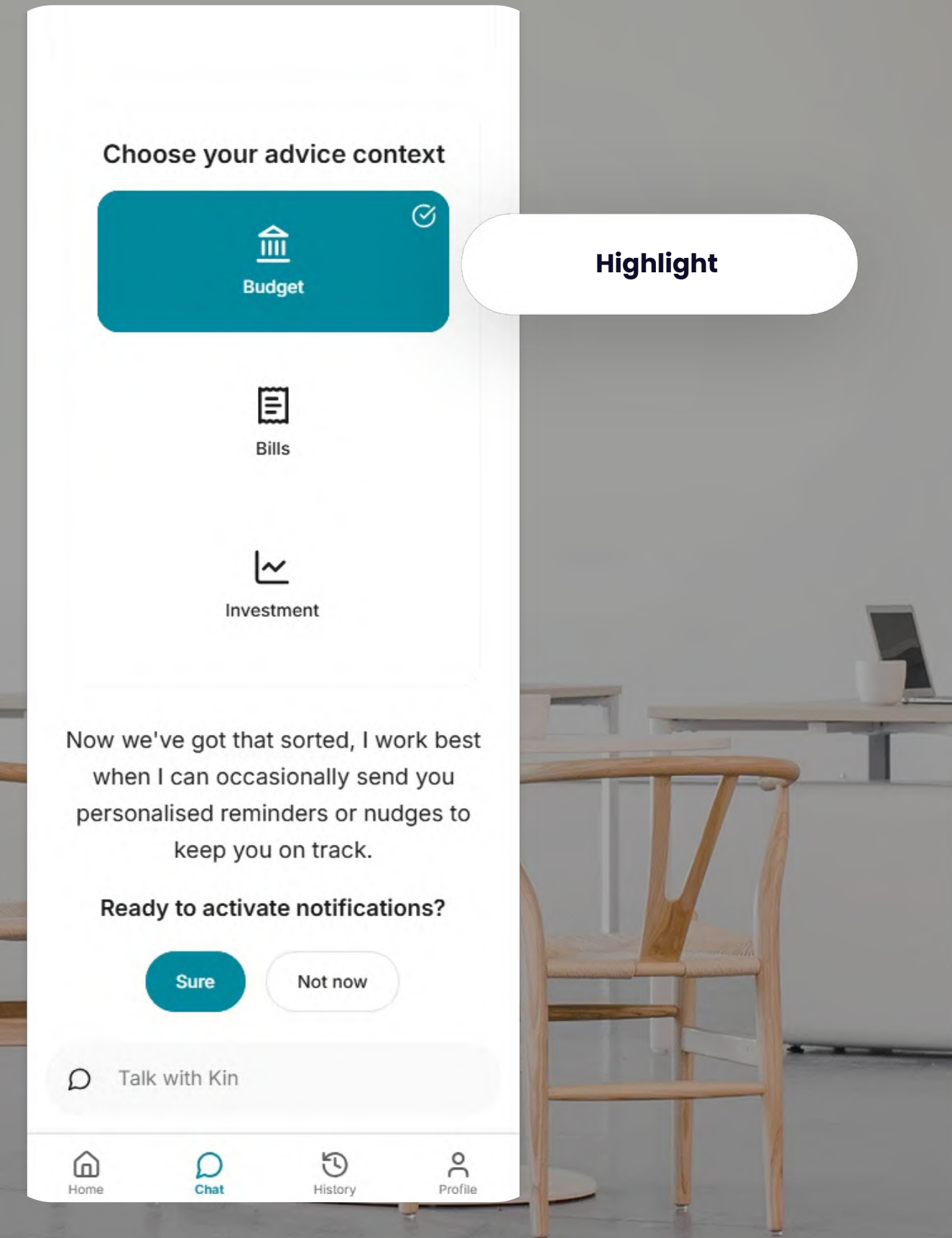
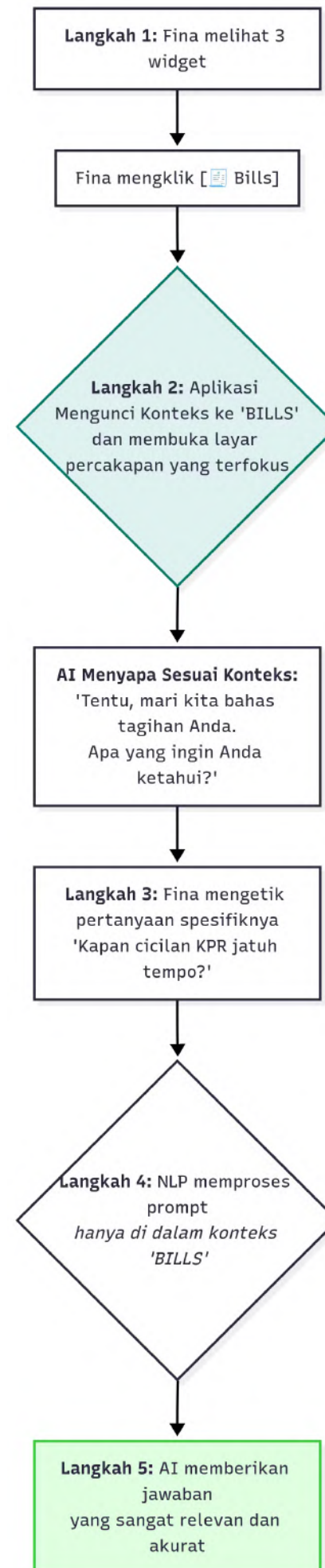
AI WIDGET INTERFACE

Proactive Alerts & Summaries

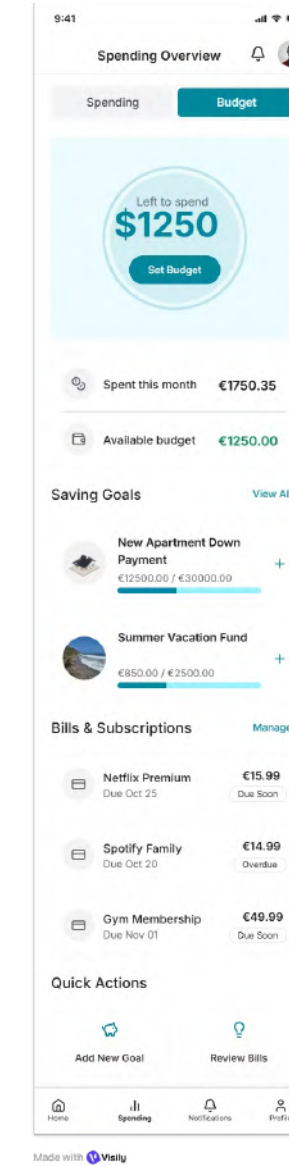
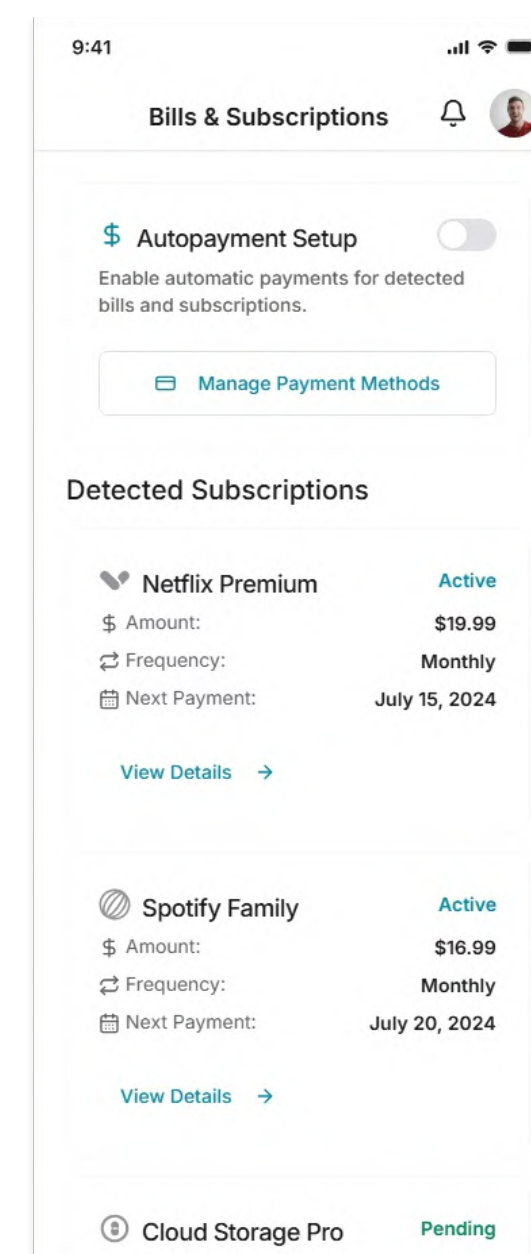
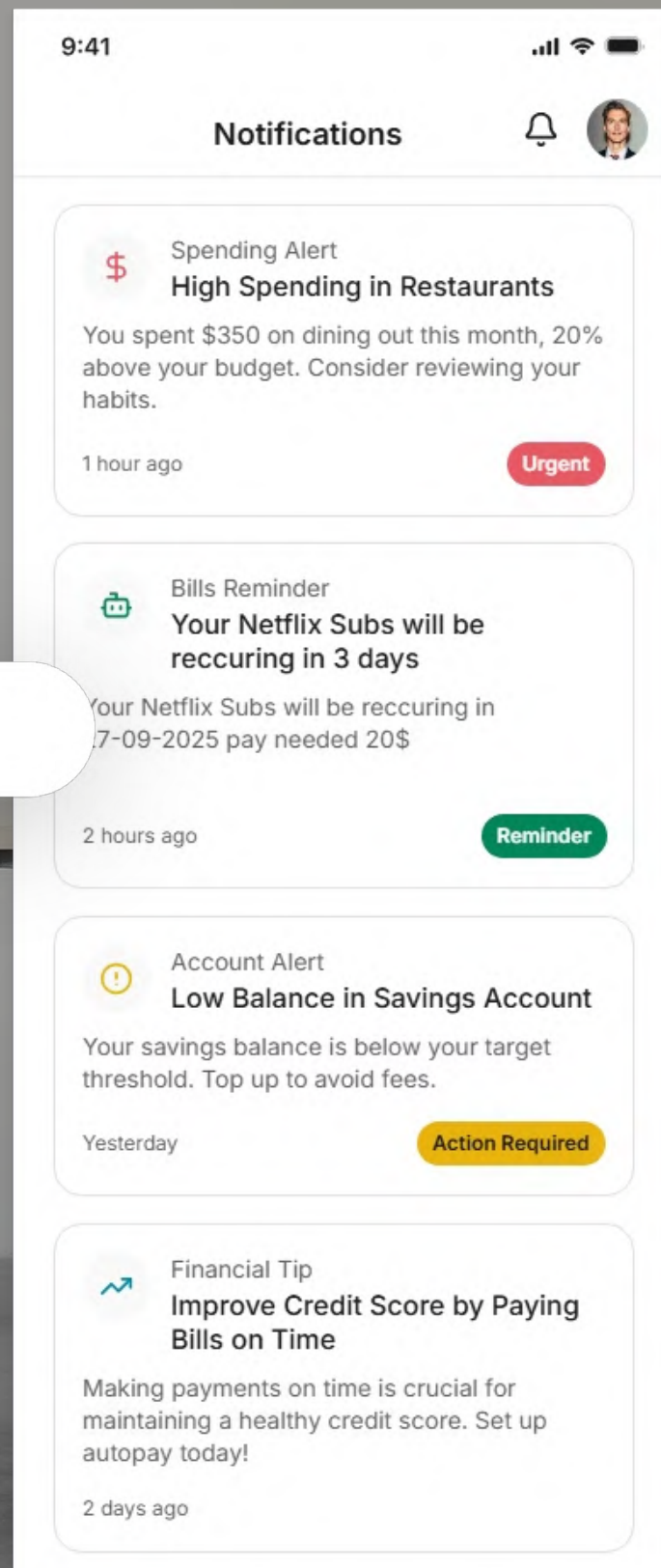
AI WIDGET INTERFACE

AI Advice Widget

- The free-text chatbot is replaced with a widget-based selection screen (Investment, Bills, Budget).
 - Clicking a widget opens a constrained conversational UI, locking the AI into that specific context.
 - The user is then free to type specific questions within that focused topic, ensuring relevant answers.
- ☑ **For the User:** It provides upfront clarity while still giving them the freedom to ask specific questions. This eliminates frustration.
 - ☑ **For the AI:** The NLP's job becomes significantly easier. It no longer has to guess the general topic; it only needs to understand the details within a pre-defined context. This dramatically increases accuracy



Highlight

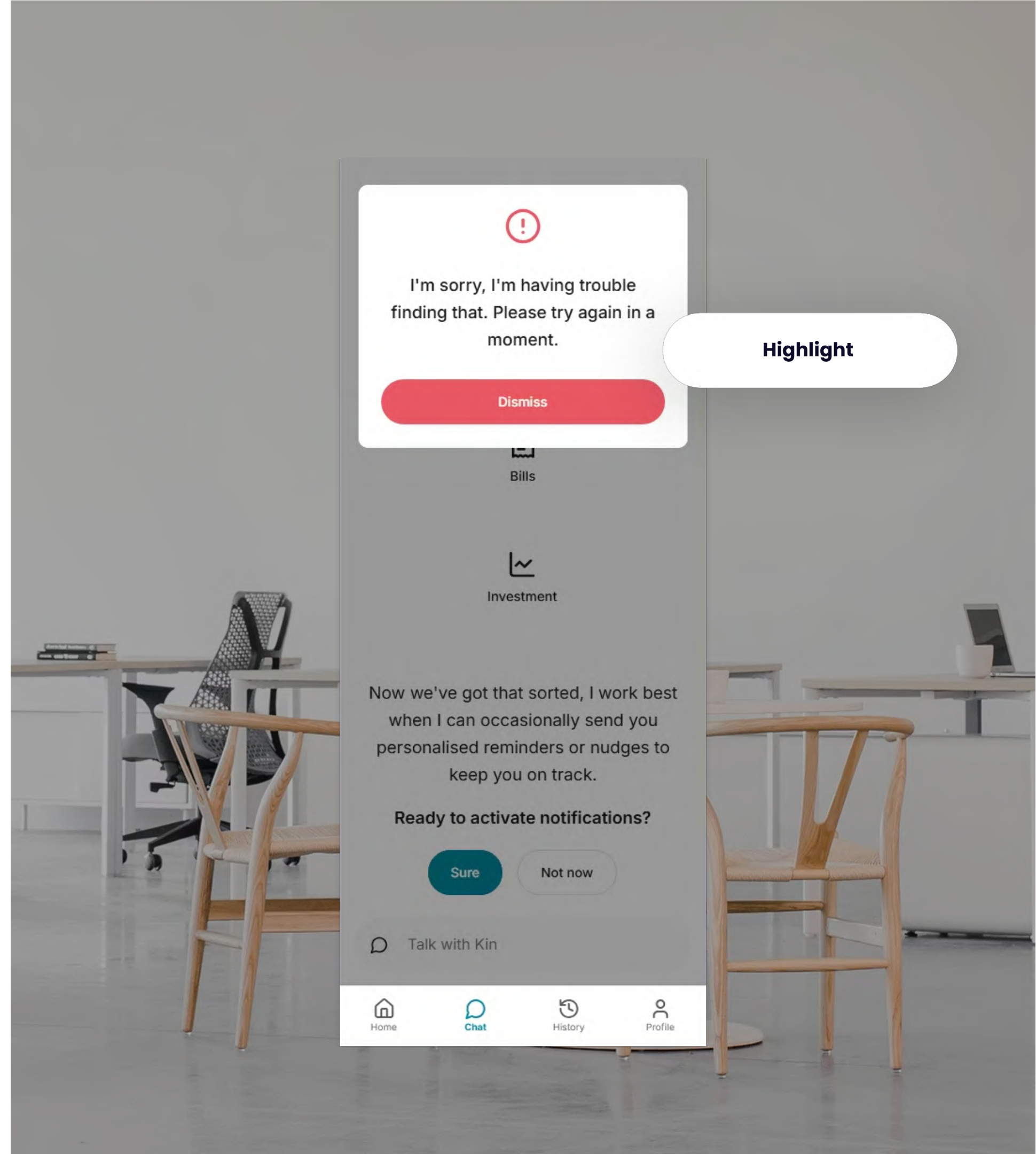


Proactive Alerts & Summaries

- A backend system that automatically detects recurring subscriptions and bills from transaction history.
- Proactive push notifications are sent to users 3-5 days before a detected payment is due.
- An automatic weekly spending summary is generated and delivered via notification and an in-app card.

Safe Fallback Redesign

- The flawed "fallback to investment" logic is **completely removed** from the pipeline.
- A new, **honest global error handler** is implemented.
 - When the system fails, it displays a clear UX message like, *"I'm sorry, I'm having trouble finding that. Please try again in a moment."*





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